BY ORDER OF THE
SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

AIR FORCE TACTICS, TECHNIQUES, AND PROCEDURES 3-10.3

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Tactical Doctrine

COUNTERINTELLIGENCE SUPPORT TO FORCE PROTECTION IN HIGHLY CONTESTED OPERATIONS

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This Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (AFTTP) describes activities the Air Force Office of Special Investigations (AFOSI) employs in support of Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD) 31-1, *Integrated Defense*. AFOSI conducts investigations, operations, and counterintelligence (CI) collection activities to find, fix, track, and neutralize adversary threats to enable Department of the Air Force (DAF) operations. This AFTTP describes command and organizational relationships, execution using functional capabilities, and training requirements to conduct effective CI support to force protection (CISFP). While these tactic, technique, and procedure principles are focused on expeditionary operations in high threat locations, the tactical doctrine principles remain the same for home-station operations. This AFTTP applies to Regular Air Force, the United States Space Force, Air Force Reserve, the Air National Guard, and civilian employees of the DAF. The doctrine prescribed in this document is authoritative, but not directive. Ensure all records generated from processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility using the DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*. Route DAF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate career field functional manager's chain of command. This publication may be supplemented at any level, but all supplements that directly implement it must be routed to Secretary of the Air Force, Inspector General, Special Investigations (SAF/IGX), for coordination prior to certification and approval.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document has been revised and needs to be completely reviewed. Changes include administrative updates, added clarifying verbiage, and an emphasis on the importance of collaborating with Department of Defense (DoD) and DAF planners.

Chapter 1

COUNTERINTELLIGENCE SUPPORT TO FORCE PROTECTION OVERVIEW

1.1. Overview. Air Force Mission Directive (AFMD) 39, *Air Force Office of Special Investigations*, states the mission and communicates responsibilities of AFOSI, a Field Operating Agency under the Inspector General of the Department of the Air Force (SAF/IG). AFOSI is a federal law enforcement and CI agency and combat-ready military organization that provides DAF law enforcement and CI capabilities across all domains, as directed by the Secretary of the Air Force, to protect the designated vital interests of the DAF, DoD, and United States (US) Government from adversary threats. Adversary threats include terrorists, insider threats, foreign intelligence entities, criminals, and enemy forces. AFOSI, utilizing law enforcement and CI authorities, neutralizes threats with appropriate interagency, joint, and combined forces, primarily through CISFP.

1.2. Counterintelligence Support to Force Protection. CISFP is the employment of AFOSI capabilities in support of friendly force protection (FP) efforts. FP includes preventive measures taken to mitigate hostile actions against personnel, resources, facilities, and critical information. AFOSI operates inside and outside of established base perimeters and is the DAF lead for identifying, locating, and tracking adversaries threatening US and allied personnel, resources, facilities, and critical information. CISFP provides commanders situational awareness, drives FP condition changes, and forewarns of possible attacks. AFOSI conducts the following activities in support of FP: CI investigations and operations; offensive CI operations; CI collection activities, such as military CI collections, liaison, threat briefings, tactical debriefings, field interviews, and tactical questioning; site exploitation (SE); surveillance, counter surveillance, and surveillance detection; protective service operations; CI activities in cyberspace; threat assessments and analysis; and CI functional services, such as technical services, technical surveillance countermeasures, polygraph, and credibility assessments. Additionally, AFOSI provides traditional law enforcement investigative capabilities which may add to the non-kinetic solutions supporting the DAF mission.

1.3. Counterthreat Operations. As a subset of CISFP, AFOSI executes Counterthreat Operations (CTO) in hostile and uncertain environments to find, fix, track, neutralize, and assess threats to create a sustained permissive environment for air, space, and cyberspace operations. Threats to active airfields may extend far beyond the area designated as a base boundary, including aircraft approach and departure corridors and indirect fire attacks to taxiing and parked aircraft. To address these threats, the air component uses the base security zone construct to plan for and consider the ground threats and hazards that could affect airfield operations. AFOSI CTO supports these efforts by seamlessly collecting, fusing, and disseminating intelligence on threats to the base security zone from a broad array of sources on a continual basis.

1.3.1. CTO utilizes intelligence-driven operations employing information derived from multiple intelligence and CI sources. Successful CTO requires deliberate collaboration, coordination, and deconfliction between AFOSI personnel and entities of various US and foreign partner agencies. A whole-of-government and interservice approach, coupled with partnerships from host nation law enforcement and intelligence services, effectively neutralize threats and foster DAF interests.

1.3.2. AFOSI executes CTO by integrating all AFOSI capabilities into the "kill chain" cycle

(find, fix, track, neutralize, and assess) to achieve the desired effects. In joint or coalition environments, AFOSI integrates its capabilities into joint, coalition, or host-nation "kill chain" processes. CTO tactical doctrine is a compilation of knowledge and expertise and describes the appropriate AFOSI role in integrated defense in hostile and uncertain environments. AFOSI executes CISFP in permissive environments and friendly foreign countries.

1.4. Planning. CISFP supports military operations by providing threat information to commanders at all levels, from combatant commands to subordinate joint forces. Commanders depend on timely, accurate threat information and intelligence, including the adversary's disposition, tactics, intent, and capabilities, to inform their decision-making processes and better understand the operational environment (OE). AFOSI units should develop CISFP plans focused on providing the commander with the intelligence required to create desired effects and achieve operational objectives. These plans should be cross-referenced with Base Defense Plans and other joint operational defense plans to ensure synergy of operations.

1.4.1. CISFP plans must consider the relevant, local aspects of the OE, such as the adversary and other actors, and factors such as political, military, economic, social, information, and infrastructure systems. CISFP plans consist of, but are not limited to, a unit's mission, map layout illustrating the base security zone, areas of concern/areas of influence, focused collection requirements, identified threats, and potential adversary courses of action. Such planning should also be aligned with and responsive to Commanders' collection and operational priorities to ensure proper synchronization, unity of effort, prioritization, collaboration, and fusion between tactical planning and strategic initiatives. CISFP planning should routinely incorporate and collaborate with joint and departmental planning and guidance, to include collaboration with relevant planning staffs at the Major Command and Field Command levels, Joint Force Counterintelligence and Human Intelligence staff element, Counterintelligence Coordinating Authority, and Combatant Command collection managers.

1.4.2. When planning CTO, the friendly freedom of maneuver along with adversary capability and intent, in the base security zone, must be considered when assessing how any outside-the-wire actions will be executed. AFOSI should only conduct unilateral CTO activities in a hostile environment when US and/or coalition forces are assessed as dominating the ground defense area. When US and/or coalition forces do not dominate the ground defense area, AFOSI senior leaders and supported commanders must assess the minimum enabler capabilities required to mitigate risk for any outside-the-wire activity by AFOSI personnel. If requisite enablers are not in place, AFOSI personnel should only operate as part of larger maneuver units.

1.4.3. AFOSI agents conducting CTO should conduct formal pre-mission briefings, rehearsals of concept drills, and post-mission debriefings. Mission briefings should, at a minimum, include any foreign and domestic mission participants to ensure compatibility of gear, communications equipment, communication details for quick reaction forces and emergency medical services, routes, objectives, and mission understanding. Supporting partners, such as Joint Terminal Attack Controllers, Explosive Ordnance Disposal teams, or K-9 Handlers, are encouraged to participate in mission planning and support CTO activities. Battle Drills should be conducted before every mission, when AFOSI agents are teamed with a Security Forces Tactical Security Element (TSE).

1.5. Training. Executing successful CISFP requires training and familiarity in multiple CI disciplines, working with interagency and coalition partners, and diplomacy. Additionally, due to

the inherent danger of CTO missions, all efforts should be made to maximize training. Effective ground combat skills are imperative to survival in hostile, highly contested, or uncertain environments with degraded communications. Initial and recurring field training in perishable skills is vital and should be conducted both in pre-deployment and in theater. Refer to **Attachment 2** for examples of skills that AFOSI agents and analysts should be trained prior to conducting CTO. Refer to **Attachment 3** for the recommended reading list for additional CISFP mission and guidance references and resources.

1.5.1. The United States Air Force Special Investigations Academy provides expeditionary activities to train AFOSI agents in realistic scenarios to perform efficiently and effectively in high-risk locations. This training is a team-centered, operationally intense, execution-based immersion course designed to train agents in core tactical skills. Curriculum focuses on perishable skill sets used in hostile or non-permissive environments.

1.5.2. Prior to a contingency deployment or assignment, all military and civilian AFOSI personnel are required to attend mandatory advanced training.

Chapter 2

JOINT AND NATIONAL INTELLIGENCE ORGANIZATIONS, RESPONSIBILITIES, AND PROCEDURES

2.1. Organization. AFOSI prepares and organizes combat-ready forces to meet the needs of the DAF. This implies a high level of training, flexibility in organization and equipment, and professional leadership. Although a standard force structure is not realistic for all contingencies, a deployed AFOSI force should have the following elements to effectively conduct CISFP in concert with joint or combined command goals and objectives.

2.1.1. Deployed AFOSI expeditionary leaders, detachment commanders, or special agents-in-charge, report directly to the designated agent who is aligned with, or coordinates closely with, the Commander of Air Force Forces staff.

2.1.2. AFOSI agents should be trained in the CI collection activities listed in **paragraph 1.2**, possess the competencies listed in **Attachment 2** and in the CTO Execution Cycle during the requisite pre-deployment training prior to conducting CISFP activities in an expeditionary environment.

2.1.3. Deployed administrative personnel generally have the requisite training and security clearances to conduct support functions (e.g., office management, human resources, executive support, postal or official mail, commander programs, and limited client level information technology support) that enable the AFOSI unit or personnel to conduct the CISFP mission.

2.1.4. Depending on the threat, AFOSI units and personnel should conduct CISFP with dedicated TSE in contested, complex, hostile and uncertain environments. A TSE provides the manpower, equipment, and firepower to enhance freedom of movement beyond the established base perimeter, independently of other ground maneuver units.

2.1.5. AFOSI units should have embedded analysts with the requisite skills and training to analyze adversary threats. AFOSI embedded analysts should continuously gather and fuse relevant threat information from a broad array of sources. CI analysis helps focus collection and targeting activities.

2.1.6. AFOSI units should have embedded linguists specializing in native language, dialects, and cultural nuances, in the OE. The linguists should be vetted and have appropriate security clearances.

2.1.7. AFOSI units should have organic intelligence community capability within units conducting CISFP mission. These capabilities help provide FP and expand other operational competencies.

2.2. Command Relationships. AFOSI supports combatant command theater campaign plans beginning with the campaign planning phase and continues throughout the range of military operations, such as security cooperation, crisis response, and large-scale combat operations. Therefore, command relationships with supported commands vary across this spectrum. AFOSI commanders direct the activities of those forces assigned or attached to an AFOSI unit. Command relationships in a joint environment for AFOSI operations are described in JP 3-10, *Joint Security Operations in Theater*. When supporting a Secretary of Defense-approved operation, command authority for AFOSI forces conducting CISFP is delegated from the Joint Force Commander,

through the Commander of Air Force Forces, to the designated senior deployed agent. The AFOSI chain of command always maintains administrative control of AFOSI forces.

2.2.1. The Commander of Air Force Forces exercises operational control over AFOSI CISFP activities. The Secretary of the Air Force retains responsibility for law enforcement, CI investigations, and associated matters, and exercises this responsibility through the Commander, AFOSI (AFOSI/CC). In the case of forces attached to another Service, responsive to a validated Request for Forces, operational control may be delegated to the commander holding operational control over all Request for Forces.

2.2.2. AFOSI personnel performing the CISFP mission in a Joint Operational Area not attached to an Air Expeditionary Task Force are normally under the administrative control of the AFOSI senior deployed agent in theater (e.g., personnel providing support to a contingency response group or contingency response element).

2.2.3. AFOSI routinely requires additional support elements to effectively conduct CISFP in concert with Service or joint command goals and objectives. When AFOSI requires DAF forces to provide additional support elements, support requirements should be defined in a component's Operations Order, support plan, or similar issuance, as appropriate for the location and area of operations. When TSE is part of the CTO package, AFOSI is the primary customer and will receive priority in mission planning. Conflicts between AFOSI and TSE may occur depending on theater dynamics, and the type of support required to achieve service or joint command objectives. It is imperative that AFOSI and TSE leaders resolve any such conflicts expeditiously at the lowest level possible, due to a high possibility of degraded or unavailable reach back communications in environments where disagreements may manifest.

2.2.4. AFOSI detachment commanders or special agents-in-charge normally coordinate their unit's CTO activities in hostile, highly contested, and uncertain environments with the appropriate base operations center (e.g., Base Defense Operations Center, Tactical Operations Center, Battle Space Owner), AFOSI Seat of Government and Force Protection Detachments, US Embassies and country teams, and maintain communications with that element to facilitate freedom of movement, unity of effort, and safety of forces. AFOSI personnel, when operating in a joint and/or combined environment, must understand the rules of engagement, or the rules for the Use of Force, established by the joint force commander. AFOSI personnel should establish standard operating procedures for situations of degraded or unavailable communications.

Chapter 3

COUNTERTHREAT OPERATIONS EXECUTION CYCLE

3.1. Overview. CISFP contributes to a keen awareness of the operating environment including Intelligence Preparation of the OE, and it incorporates the full range of functions and activities AFOSI uses to find, fix, track, neutralize, and assess the adversary. CTO activities help create a sustained permissive environment for air, space, and cyberspace operations. CTO capabilities vary widely depending on their application combined with the prevailing threat, threat state, environment, friendly forces available, rules of engagement, rules for the Use of Force, applicable laws, and other factors that characterize a specific operational area.

3.2. The Counterthreat Operations Execution Cycle Five Phases. Find, fix, track, neutralize, and assess (reference **Figure 3.1**).

3.2.1. Find. The find phase requires clearly defined guidance. This guidance is typically provided via established priority intelligence requirements and associated collection requirements. These requirements drive CI collection planning and operations. CI collection leads to the detection of current and emerging targets. Tailored all-source analysis drives and focuses CI collection activities. AFOSI personnel should be familiar with the multiple targeting cycles present in a joint or combined operating environment and can be attached to support operational elements/capabilities in a limited fashion when skill sets specific to AFOSI (SE, field interviews, tactical questioning, and military CI collection) are requested and approved with agent safety as the priority.

3.2.2. Fix. The fix phase uses analysis and prioritization to determine if an emerging target is worthy of engagement. It may begin when an emerging target is detected or soon thereafter. When an emerging target is detected, sensors (human source networks, intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance platforms), liaison activities, specialist activities, and information operations are focused on confirming target identity and precise location. Target location and other information must be accurately refined to permit tracking and neutralization. The completion of the fix phase results in a confirmed target with a designated CTO named operation.

3.2.3. Track. Tracking is the initiation and/or continuation of specific and directed CI collection and investigative activities. Tracking is also accomplished with the employment of specific intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance platforms. Information obtained during this phase is compiled and documented in a comprehensive target package.

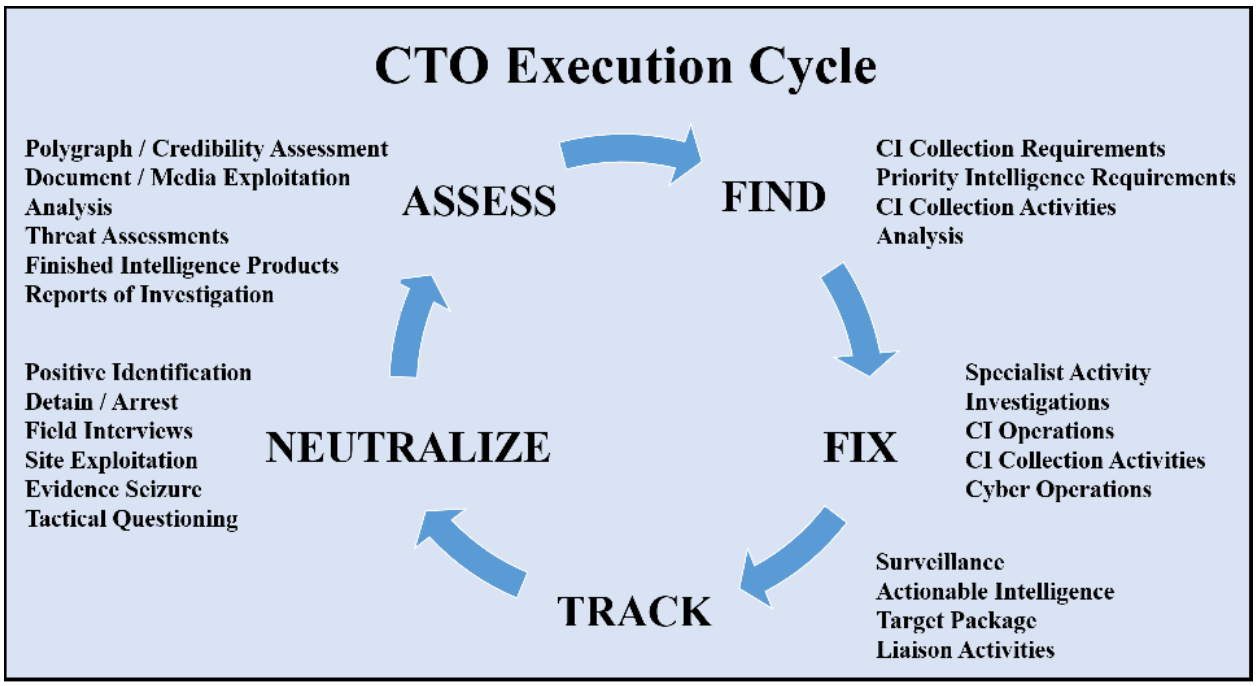
3.2.4. Neutralize. The neutralize phase begins after collected information is determined to be credible. Actionable intelligence or a comprehensive target package may be provided to a direct-action authority to neutralize the threat. AFOSI activities in this phase may include positive identification; surveillance (physical, technical, or both); apprehension; recruitment; influence operations; and computer network exploitation. AFOSI forces disseminate actionable intelligence to Direct Action units and operations centers to support exploitation, seizure, SE, cordon and search, detention, or capture and kill operations.

3.2.4.1. Careful consideration of the intelligence gain-loss balance must be made. It may be appropriate to delay engagement to allow better intelligence gathering and validation of veracity on a network of threats rather than act on a single target.

3.2.4.2. AFOSI normally coordinates with maneuver units within the battlespace for target package execution in hostile and uncertain environments. Following the execution of a CTO target package, AFOSI agents may participate in field interviews, tactical questioning, and SE, including documenting the site, searching the site, prioritizing exfiltration, seizing evidence, and exploiting materials.

3.2.5. Assess. Tactical assessments determine the effectiveness of executed CTO activities. The principal question answered during the assess phase is whether desired effects and objectives were achieved. In cases of fleeting targets, quick assessments from trusted sources may be required to make expeditious re-attack recommendations.

Figure 3.1. The CTO Execution Cycle.



3.3. Reporting. CTO reports contribute to commanders' overall awareness of the OE. AFOSI reports are disseminated to the intelligence and law enforcement communities, as appropriate, at all levels and during all phases of the CTO execution cycle. These reports include, but are not limited to, suspicious incident reports, intelligence information reports, comprehensive target packages, analytical products, and spot reports. In certain situations, AFOSI reports the results of activities, such as field interviews and SE, including biometric evidence from accredited laboratory reports to host-nation counterparts for inclusion into prosecution processes. After proper exploitation, AFOSI can provide material evidence collected during SE directly to host nation law enforcement and intelligence services for their use.

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Brigadier General, USAF
Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFMD 39, *Air Force Office of Special Investigations (AFOSI),* 12 February 2024

AFPD 31-1, *Integrated Defense*, 21 June 2018

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program,* 23 March 2020

JP 3-10, *Joint Security Operations in Theater,* 25 July 2019

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFMD—Air Force Mission Directive

AFOSI—Air Force Office of Special Investigations

AFPD—Air Force Policy Directive

AFTTP—Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

CI—Counterintelligence

CISFP—Counterintelligence Support to Force Protection

CTO—Counterthreat Operations

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DoD—Department of Defense

FP—Force Protection

JP—Joint Publication

OE—Operational Environment

SE—Site Exploitation

TSE—Tactical Security Element

US—United States

Office Symbols

AFOSI/CC—Commander, AFOSI

SAF/IG—Inspector General of the Department of the Air Force

SAF/IGX—Secretary of the Air Force, Inspector General, Special Investigations Directorate

Terms

Administrative Control—Direction or exercise of authority over subordinate or other organizations in respect to administration and support.

Counterintelligence (CI)—Information gathered, and activities conducted to identify, deceive, exploit, disrupt, or protect against espionage, other intelligence activities, sabotage, or assassinations conducted for or on behalf of foreign powers, organizations or persons or their agents, or international terrorist organizations or activities.

Counterintelligence Support to Force Protection (CISFP)—CI activities conducted to counter international terrorism and support the overall DoD force protection effort.

Counter Surveillance—Measures taken to prevent or detect surveillance, particularly by hostile or unauthorized parties. It involves techniques, strategies, and methods used to counteract or evade surveillance, such as observation, monitoring, or eavesdropping, by individuals, organizations, or governments.

Direct Action—Short-duration strikes, and other small-scale offensive actions conducted as a special operation in hostile, denied, or diplomatically sensitive environments and which employ specialized military capabilities to seize, destroy, capture, exploit, recover, or damage designated targets.

Hostile Environment—OE in which hostile forces have control, as well as the intent and capability, to effectively oppose or react to the operations that a unit intends to conduct.

Liaison—Contact or intercommunication maintained between elements of military forces or other agencies to ensure mutual understanding and unity of purpose and action.

Neutralize—1. As pertains to military operations, to render ineffective or unusable. 2. To render enemy personnel or materiel incapable of interfering with a particular operation. 3. To render safe mines, bombs, missiles, and booby traps. 4. To make harmless anything contaminated with a chemical agent.

Operational Control—Authority to perform those functions of command over subordinate forces involving organizing and employing commands and forces, assigning tasks, designating objectives, and giving authoritative direction necessary to accomplish the mission.

Permissive Environment—OE in which host country military and law enforcement agencies have control as well as the intent and capability to assist operations that a unit intends to conduct.

Positive Identification—An identification derived from observation and analysis of target characteristics including visual recognition, electronic support systems, non-cooperative target recognition techniques, identification friend or foe systems, or other physics-based identification techniques.

Rules Of Engagement—Directives issued by competent military authority that delineate the circumstances and limitations under which US forces initiate and/or continue combat engagement with other forces encountered.

Site Exploitation (SE)—A series of activities to recognize, collect, process, preserve, and analyze information, personnel, and/or materiel found during the conduct of operations.

Surveillance—Systematic observation of aerospace, surface, or subsurface areas, places, persons, or things, by visual, aural, electronic, photographic, or other means.

Tactical Questioning—Direct questioning by any DoD personnel of a captured or detained person to obtain time-sensitive tactical intelligence at or near the point of capture or detention and consistent with applicable law.

Target Packages—Targeting information provided by AFOSI to direct action units and authorities (Army, Special Operations Forces, coalition forces, host nation police etc.) for the purposes of identifying and neutralizing threats.

Technical Surveillance Countermeasures—Techniques used to detect, neutralize, and/or exploit a wide variety of foreign technical surveillance technologies that are used to obtain unauthorized access to classified and sensitive information.

Uncertain Environment—OE in which host government forces, whether opposed to or receptive to operations that a unit intends to conduct, do not have totally effective control of the territory and population in the intended operational area.

Attachment 2

SKILLS LIST

Table A2.1. Skills List.

Advanced Firearms and Tactics	Recognize and Report Improvised Explosive Devices
Deployed Concept of Operations	Self-Defensive Tactics
Deployed Liaison	Small Unit Tactics
Deployed Stress Management	Survival, Evasion, Resistance and Escape
Deployed Theater and Cultural Orientation	Tactical Combat Casualty Care
Developing Standard Operating Procedures	Tactical Communications
Global Positioning System Use	Tactical Foot Movements
High Value Target Packages	Tactical Questioning / Interviews
Individual and Field Equipment Use	Tactical Vehicle Movements
Intelligence Information Report Writing	Terrorism / Insurgency TTPs
Land Navigation Map and Compass	Threat Detection / Attack Recognition
Military CI Collections Operations	Urban Operations
Night Operations	Vehicle Search and Security
Night Vision Techniques & Procedures	Working with Linguists
Operational Planning	Working with Ground Maneuver Units
Personal Security Operations	Commercial Armored Vehicle Driving
Note: Examples of skills in which AFOSI agents should be trained prior to conducting CTO.	

Attachment 3

READING LIST

Figure A3.1. Recommended Reading List.

DAFI 16-1402, *Counter-Insider Threat Program Management*, 10 May 2024

AFPD 31-1, *Integrated Defense,* 21 June 2018

AFTTP 3-4.7, *Contingency Response*, 3 March 2022

Army Field Manual 3-24, *Insurgencies and Countering Insurgencies,* 13 May 2014

DHE-M 3301.001 (S//NF), *Collection Requirements, Reporting, and Evaluation Procedures (U)*, 1 February 2012

DoD Dictionary of Military and Associated Terms, February 2025

JP 3-0, *Joint Campaigns and Operations*, 18 June 2022

JP 3-10, *Joint Security Operations in Theater,* 25 July 2019